ONE LAST PLATE

THE TABLE WE SET TOGETHER

We began by asking you to pull up a chair. Now, fifty states later, the plates are nearly cleared—and this is the part of the meal that has always mattered most.

Somewhere back at the start of this book, we said that food is how we remember where we've been. We hope, by now, that the idea has cooked all the way through. Because if you made even a handful of these dishes, you didn't just cross the country—you tasted it. You stood, for an evening, in a New Haven pizzeria and an Alabama backyard and a Lowcountry rice kitchen, and you carried a little of each of them home.

That was always the point. These recipes were never really about the food alone. They were about the hands that first made them, and the reasons those hands reached for what was near: the catfish in the river, the huckleberries on the mountainside, the hog that could not be wasted, the wheat that came across an ocean in someone's pocket. Every dish in this book is a small act of ingenuity and love, passed down until it landed, somehow, on your stove. You are the newest cook in a very long line.

And you've added something of your own now, too. A little too much pepper, maybe, or a substitution born of an empty cupboard, or the particular way your kitchen smells when the oven has been on all afternoon. That is how these dishes have always survived—not by staying the same, but by being made again, by someone new, in a place the last cook never imagined. The recipe on the page is only the beginning of the sentence. You finish it.

So keep this book somewhere it can get a little splattered. Lend it out. Argue with it. Make the cobbler for a birthday and the chowder for a cold night and the hot chicken for someone you're trying to impress. A country, in the end, is just a great many tables—and every time you set one, you make a little more room at it.

Thank you for pulling up a chair.
The plate is always yours to pass.

FROM OUR TABLE TO YOURS

MENUS FOR THE OCCASION

Fifty states make a long and happy table, but a good meal is rarely eaten one dish at a time. What follows are a few gatherings drawn from across the country—plates that were never neighbors by geography, but that sit down together beautifully all the same. Cook a whole menu, or borrow a single dish and build your own. There is no wrong way to set this table.

The Fourth of July

Smoke, char, and something cold and sweet to finish—the country's birthday, coast to coast.

Grilled Chicken Sliders with Alabama White Sauce · *Alabama* 14
Elk Burgers with Spicy Huckleberry BBQ Sauce · *Montana* 126
Fried Green Tomatoes · *North Carolina* 154
Cast-Iron Skillet Cornbread · *Oklahoma* 166
Georgia Peach Cobbler · *Georgia* 52

A Sunday Supper

The slow, unhurried meal that anchors a week—a roast at the center and a pie to linger over.

Wild Rice Soup · *Minnesota* 112
Buffet-Style Prime Rib Roast with Pan Jus · *Nevada* 134
Funeral Potatoes · *Utah* 200
Apple Pie with Cheddar Cheese · *Vermont* 204

An East Coast Seaside Table

Everything the eastern U.S. coast gives up—briny, buttery, and best eaten with your sleeves pushed up. Choose one or two for a small meal, or serve all four when family and friends are joining.

New England Clam Chowder · *Massachusetts* 104
Steamed Crabs · *Maryland* 100
Lobster Roll · *Maine* 96
Key Lime Grilled Grouper and Coconut Rice · *Florida* 48

A Cozy Winter Table

For the short, cold days—deep pots, long simmers, and warmth that fills the whole kitchen. Only one of these will do.

Burgoo · *Kentucky* 85
Gumbo · *Louisiana* 92
Knoephla Soup · *North Dakota* 158

A Weekend Breakfast

The meal worth waking up for, made slow—a griddle going and no one watching the clock.

Denver Omelet · *Colorado* 36
Scrapple Breakfast Sandwich · *Delaware* 44
Buckwheat Pancakes · *West Virginia* 218
Biscochitos · *New Mexico* 146

Game Day

Food built for a crowd and a couch—handheld, hearty, and happy to be shared.

Philly Cheesesteak · *Pennsylvania* 174
Chicago Dog · *Illinois* 66
Cincinnati Chili · *Ohio* 162
Chislic · *South Dakota* 188
Kringle · *Wisconsin* 222

A Road-Trip Picnic

Wrapped, packed, and carried—the flavors of the open road, meant to be eaten somewhere with a view.

Michigan-Style Cornish Pasty · *Michigan* 108
Bierock · *Kansas* 80
Fish Tacos · *California* 31
Gooey Butter Cake · *Missouri* 121

COOK WITH CONFIDENCE

A GUIDE TO ALLERGENS

Every kitchen has someone to cook around—gluten to avoid, shellfish to steer clear of, a nut that can't come near the table. This guide sorts every dish in the book (sauces and sides are listed with the dish they serve) so you can find what fits, or see at a glance what to adjust. Where an allergen hides in a single, swappable ingredient, we've said so—because a good recipe should bend to the cook, not the other way around.

Free of All Major Allergens

No wheat, dairy, egg, shellfish, fish, peanut, tree nut, soy, or sesame in the recipe as written.

Kalua Pork · *Hawaii* 56
Corned Beef Boiled Dinner · *New Hampshire* 138
Chislic* · *South Dakota* 188

**Fried in vegetable oil, not peanut oil.*

Gluten-Free

Naturally, as written—always confirm broths, sauces, and seasoning blends carry no hidden wheat.

Akutaq · *Alaska* 18
Fried Catfish with Arkansas-Style Tartar Sauce · *Arkansas* 26
Denver Omelet · *Colorado* 36
Key Lime Grilled Grouper and Coconut Rice · *Florida* 48
Burgoo · *Kentucky* 85
Buffet-Style Prime Rib Roast with Pan Jus · *Nevada* 134
Corned Beef Boiled Dinner · *New Hampshire* 138
Johnnycakes · *Rhode Island* 178
Gullah Shrimp and Sausage Perloo · *South Carolina* 184
Chislic · *South Dakota* 188
Cedar-Planked Salmon with Honey-Balsamic Glaze · *Washington* 212
Cowboy Cutthroat Trout · *Wyoming* 226

Dairy-Free

Naturally, as written—some offer butter or cheese only as an optional finish, easily left out.

Grilled Chicken Sliders with Alabama White Sauce · *Alabama* 14
Akutaq · *Alaska* 18
Kalua Pork · *Hawaii* 56
Chicago Dog · *Illinois* 66
Burgoo · *Kentucky* 85
Gumbo · *Louisiana* 92
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Chislic · *South Dakota* 188
Chili con Carne · *Texas* 196
Cedar-Planked Salmon with Honey-Balsamic Glaze · *Washington* 212

RECIPES THAT CONTAIN

Contains Shellfish

Crab, clam, lobster, or shrimp—central to the dish and not removable.

White Clam Apizza · *Connecticut* 40
Gumbo · *Louisiana* 92
Lobster Roll · *Maine* 96
Steamed Crabs · *Maryland* 100
New England Clam Chowder · *Massachusetts* 104
Gullah Shrimp and Sausage Perloo · *South Carolina* 184

Contains Fish

The fish is the dish and cannot be removed.

Akutaq · *Alaska* 18
Fried Catfish with Arkansas-Style Tartar Sauce · *Arkansas* 26
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Key Lime Grilled Grouper and Coconut Rice · *Florida* 48
Cedar-Planked Salmon with Honey-Balsamic Glaze · *Washington* 212
Cowboy Cutthroat Trout · *Wyoming* 226

Contains Fish—Hidden Source

Fish is present only through Worcestershire sauce, which contains anchovy. A fish-free Worcestershire (or a splash of soy or coconut aminos) removes it.

Finger Steaks with Fry Sauce and French Fries · *Idaho* 61
Burgoo · *Kentucky* 85
Gumbo · *Louisiana* 92
Elk Burgers with Spicy Huckleberry BBQ Sauce · *Montana* 126
Cincinnati Chili · *Ohio* 162
Philly Cheesesteak · *Pennsylvania* 174
Peanut Soup · *Virginia* 208

Contains Eggs

Whole eggs, yolks, or egg-based mayonnaise. Some appear only as an egg wash or optional binder.

Grilled Chicken Sliders with Alabama White Sauce · *Alabama* 14
Fried Catfish with Arkansas-Style Tartar Sauce · *Arkansas* 26
Fish Tacos · *California* 31
Denver Omelet · *Colorado* 36
Scrapple Breakfast Sandwich · *Delaware* 44
Finger Steaks with Fry Sauce and French Fries · *Idaho* 61
Hoosier Pie · *Indiana* 71
Ham Balls with Sweet Sauce · *Iowa* 76
Bierock · *Kansas* 80
Lobster Roll · *Maine* 96
Michigan-Style Cornish Pasty · *Michigan* 108
Mississippi Mud Pie · *Mississippi* 116
Gooey Butter Cake · *Missouri* 121
Elk Burgers with Spicy Huckleberry BBQ Sauce · *Montana* 126
Cheese Frenchee · *Nebraska* 130
Pork Roll · *New Jersey* 142
Biscochitos · *New Mexico* 146
Fried Green Tomatoes · *North Carolina* 154
Knoephla Soup · *North Dakota* 158
Cast-Iron Skillet Cornbread · *Oklahoma* 166
Apple Pie with Cheddar Cheese · *Vermont* 204
Kringle · *Wisconsin* 222

Contains Peanuts

True peanuts—peanut butter and roasted peanuts—essential to the dish.

Peanut Soup · *Virginia* 208

Contains Tree Nuts

Pecans, almonds, or coconut. In Florida coconut is central; in Mississippi and Wisconsin the nuts appear as a topping or flavoring that can often be omitted.

Key Lime Grilled Grouper and Coconut Rice · *Florida* 48
Mississippi Mud Pie · *Mississippi* 116
Kringle · *Wisconsin* 222

Contains Soy

Present through soy sauce, which can be swapped for coconut aminos.

Cedar-Planked Salmon with Honey-Balsamic Glaze · *Washington* 212

A Note on Peanut Oil

These fried recipes list "vegetable or peanut oil." Refined peanut oil is generally considered safe for most peanut allergies, and each offers vegetable oil as an equal substitute. If in any doubt, choose the vegetable oil.

Sonoran-Style Chimichanga · *Arizona* 22
Fried Catfish with Arkansas-Style Tartar Sauce · *Arkansas* 26
Fish Tacos · *California* 31
Finger Steaks with Fry Sauce and French Fries · *Idaho* 61
Cheese Frenchee · *Nebraska* 130
Jo Jo Potatoes · *Oregon* 170
Chislic · *South Dakota* 188
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Chicken Riggies · *New York* 150
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